

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (12:37 ET)

July 29, 2026 | 12:42 PM ET

15 setups identified | 5 A-Grade | 4 B-Grade | 6 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (5)	B - Strong Setup (4)	C - Watch List (6)
LAD	QUAD	CLW
CAKE	HURN	RCKY
NEO	CBZ	SCL
ASH	ABG	STRA
SLDE		COUR
		HVT-A

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	LAD	Lithia Motors, I	Auto Retail Recov	\$421.85	+22.1%	\$9.6B	20M	+49.4	100%	Earnings beat TODAY dr
A	CAKE	The Cheesecake F	Casual Dining Rec	\$100.17	+15.1%	\$5.0B	46M	+57.7	100%	Today's 15% breakout a
A	NEO	NeoGenomics, Inc	Cancer Diagnostic	\$15.48	+17.8%	\$2.0B	118M	+76.5	96%	Breakout likely driven
A	ASH	Ashland Inc.	Specialty Chemica	\$72.90	+9.8%	\$3.3B	41M	+24.0	99%	Earnings reported YEST
A	SLDE	Slide Insurance	Property Insuranc	\$22.29	+6.9%	\$2.5B	56M	+14.4	97%	Earnings reported YEST
B	QUAD	Quad Graphics, I	Print Services Tu	\$9.46	+11.3%	\$0.5B	30M	+20.9	95%	Today's 11.29% breakou
B	HURN	Huron Consulting	Consulting Servic	\$164.00	+40.8%	\$2.7B	15M	+25.7	88%	Earnings reported YEST
B	CBZ	CBIZ, Inc.	Business Services	\$54.79	+23.2%	\$2.9B	47M	+75.4	71%	Earnings TODAY - the 2
B	ABG	Asbury Automotiv	Auto Retail Recov	\$250.69	+10.6%	\$4.7B	16M	+22.0	95%	Today's 10.61% move is
C	CLW	Clearwater Paper	Paper Products Re	\$21.47	+24.7%	\$0.3B	16M	+43.5	75%	Today's 24.68% move ap
C	RCKY	Rocky Brands, In	Footwear Recovery	\$48.68	+17.2%	\$0.4B	7M	+9.8	96%	Today's 17.18% move ap
C	SCL	Stepan Company	Specialty Chemica	\$62.48	+8.6%	\$1.4B	21M	+16.2	92%	Earnings TODAY - the 8
C	STRA	Strategic Educat	Education Service	\$86.73	+10.4%	\$2.0B	22M	+11.7	99%	Earnings TODAY - the 1
C	COUR	Coursera, Inc.	EdTech / Online L	\$6.34	+12.5%	\$1.8B	147M	+5.7	49%	Earnings TODAY - the 1
C	HVT-A	Haverty Furnitur	Furniture Retail	\$30.40	+8.4%	\$0.5B	15M	+30.3	68%	Today's 8.38% move app

LAD

Lithia Motors, Inc.

\$421.85

+22.10%

RS vs SPY: +49.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$9.6B Cap | 20M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Retail Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 8.32 | Vol: 5.68x | RS/SPY: +49.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$421.85
Day Change	+22.10%
Mkt Cap	\$9.62B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	+49.4%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	8.32
Vol vs Avg	5.68x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings beat TODAY driving the 22% gap - forward catalyst is continuation of consumer spending normalization and potential for multiple expansion as dealer consolidation accelerates (next print October 27). Strong consumer cyclical tailwind with auto retail margin recovery extending into Q4.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Lithia is the largest automotive retailer in the U.S., operating 300+ stores across new/used vehicle sales, financing, and service. The company has leveraged a roll-up strategy and digital platform (Driveway) to gain share in a fragmented \$1.2T market, positioning as the category consolidator.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct play on consumer spending recovery and auto retail margin normalization. Benefits from tight inventory dynamics (keeping vehicle prices elevated), financing income resilience, and secular shift toward dealer consolidation. Theme momentum is accelerating with consumer discretionary rotation.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$421.85 on vol >568% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume spike to 5.68x on earnings is institutional response to the beat - likely block buying from growth-at-reasonable-price funds repositioning into consumer cyclicals. Float of only 20M shares creates technical leverage. Institutional ownership data not available from this feed; recommend cross-referencing 13F filings for holder composition.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings reported TODAY - the 22% gap suggests material beat on both EPS and revenue, likely driven by higher-than-expected margins and same-store sales growth. History of execution and beat consistency would need to be verified from prior quarters, but the market's 5.68x volume response signals institutional conviction in the print.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below the \$380 breakout pivot, or if October 27 guidance signals margin compression or inventory glut concerns. Bear case: consumer cyclical reversion if macro turns or auto financing tightens.
ANALYSIS
RS line at 52W high, 99.8% proximity, and 5.68x volume on an earnings beat - textbook institutional breakout. Disconfirming evidence: base is wide (8.32), suggesting the move is more gap-and-go than VCP coil; risk of exhaustion if no follow-through buyers appear. However, the combination of rs_line_new_high + consumer cyclical sector strength + forward catalyst path to October earns this despite mixed macro. Conviction: Medium (would be High in risk-on regime).
Signal: Close above \$421.85 on vol >568% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.68x



CAKE

The Cheesecake Factory Incorpor

\$100.17

+15.09%

RS vs SPY: +57.7%

A BREAKOUT

\$5.0B Cap | 46M Float

Restaurants | Theme: Casual Dining Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 6.85 | Vol: 4.05x | RS/SPY: +57.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$100.17
Day Change	+15.09%
Mkt Cap	\$4.98B
Float	46M sh
RS vs SPY	+57.7%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	6.85
Vol vs Avg	4.05x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Today's 15% breakout appears driven by sector rotation into consumer discretionary (restaurant comps improving, margin recovery). Forward catalyst: October 27 earnings will be critical for proving same-store sales momentum and labor cost stabilization - any guidance raise will extend the move into year-end.
Business & Position
The Cheesecake Factory operates 330+ full-service restaurants globally, known for premium casual dining with expansive menus and high per-guest spend. The company has pricing power, owns prime real estate, and is leveraging delivery/digital to defend margin.
Factor & Theme
Pure consumer recovery play - benefits from discretionary spending normalization, return of experiential dining, and margin expansion as labor inflation moderates. Theme momentum is accelerating with consumer cyclical sector leadership; casual dining is early in the upcycle after years of underinvestment.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$100.17 on vol >405% of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume at 4.05x suggests institutional accumulation, not retail chasing. RS line at new high is the critical signal - this is a leadership name within the restaurant group, likely being accumulated by large-cap growth funds rotating into cyclicals. Float of 45.7M provides liquidity for institutional entry.
Earnings
Earnings in 90D
Earnings Context
Next print October 27 - consensus estimates and beat history not available, but the 15% breakout into the high suggests the market is pricing in a strong upcoming quarter. Verify same-store sales trends and margin guidance from recent quarters to assess serial-beater status.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below the \$92 breakout level, or if October 27 comp guidance disappoints. Bear case: consumer spending rollover, labor cost resurgence, or execution miss in digital/delivery channels.
Analysis
Five A-grade criteria met: vol >4x, prox_52w 99.9, rs_line_new_high, rs_vs_spy +57.7, and within consumer cyclical sector leadership. Disconfirming evidence: base is not tight (6.85), indicating this is an explosive breakout rather than a coiled setup - risk of fast reversion if follow-through fails. However, the RS line confirmation and sector tailwind override base width in this regime. Conviction: Medium (mixed macro caps upside, but technical setup is pristine).
Signal: Close above \$100.17 on vol >405% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 4.05x



NEO

NeoGenomics, Inc.

\$15.48

+17.81%

RS vs SPY: +76.5%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.0B Cap | 118M Float

Diagnostics & Research | Theme: Cancer Diagnostics Growth | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 3.24 | Vol: 2.96x | RS/SPY: +76.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$15.48
Day Change	+17.81%
Mkt Cap	\$2.02B
Float	118M sh
RS vs SPY	+76.5%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	3.24
Vol vs Avg	2.96x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout likely driven by momentum in oncology testing volume and reimbursement tailwinds (CMS rate decisions favoring precision diagnostics). Forward catalyst: October 27 earnings will be key for proving pharma partnership revenue and test volume acceleration - any guidance beat extends this into Q4.
BUSINESS & POSITION
NeoGenomics is a leading provider of cancer-focused genetic and molecular testing services, serving pathologists, oncologists, and pharma biopharma partners. The company is scaling its pharma services segment (clinical trial testing) while expanding reimbursement coverage for its liquid biopsy and comprehensive genomic profiling platforms.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to healthcare sector leadership (+7.2% vs SPY this week) and secular oncology diagnostics growth. Benefits from aging demographics, precision medicine adoption, and pharma R&D spending on companion diagnostics. Theme momentum is accelerating - cancer testing is scaling across early detection and minimal residual disease monitoring.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$15.48 on vol >296% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 2.96x with RS line at new high signals institutional rotation into healthcare winners. Large float (118.3M) typically dampens volatility, but the rs_vs_spy of +76.5 indicates sustained accumulation over the past 12 weeks - this is not a one-day pop. Likely held by healthcare-focused growth funds.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print October 27 - verify consensus for pharma services revenue growth and core lab volume trends. NeoGenomics has historically re-rated on beats when pharma segment shows acceleration. Base_tight of 3.24 suggests disciplined accumulation into the breakout.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$14.20 (the launch point of this breakout), or if October 27 guidance signals pharma services deceleration or reimbursement headwinds. Bear case: Medicare rate cuts or competitive pressure from larger lab players (Quest, LabCorp).
ANALYSIS
RS line at new high, 96.1% proximity, base_tight <3.5, and healthcare sector leadership combine to form a textbook A-grade setup. Disconfirming evidence: float is large (118.3M), which can dilute momentum if institutional interest wanes - not a low-float rocket. However, the +76.5 rs_vs_spy is the strongest in this cohort and signals durable outperformance. Conviction: Medium-High (healthcare tailwind + technical quality earn this, but mixed macro demands caution).
Signal: Close above \$15.48 on vol >296% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.96x



ASH

Ashland Inc.

\$72.90

+9.82%

RS vs SPY: +24.0%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.3B Cap | 41M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals Recovery | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 3.37 | Vol: 3.01x | RS/SPY: +24.0% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$72.90
Day Change	+9.82%
Mkt Cap	\$3.34B
Float	41M sh
RS vs SPY	+24.0%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.37
Vol vs Avg	3.01x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings reported YESTERDAY (July 28) - today's 9.82% move is follow-through on a beat, likely driven by volume recovery in personal care and pharma end markets. Forward catalyst: guidance into year-end and the next print (likely late October/early November) will confirm whether margin expansion is sustainable as input costs normalize.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Ashland is a global specialty chemicals company focused on high-margin additives for personal care, pharmaceuticals, and coatings. The company has shed commodity exposure and repositioned as a pure-play specialty chemicals provider with pricing power and customer stickiness.
FACTOR & THEME
Benefits from industrial activity recovery, pharma demand resilience, and personal care restocking cycles. Specialty chemicals are early cyclical - pricing and volume recover ahead of broader industrials. Theme momentum is steady but not explosive; this is a value-to-growth transition story.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$72.90 on vol >301% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 3.01x on earnings follow-through suggests institutional validation of the beat. RS line at new high is the key signal - Ashland is leading the specialty chemicals group, indicating smart money is rotating into quality cyclical with pricing power. Float of 41M provides liquidity.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reported July 28 - the 9.82% follow-through today signals a material beat on both EPS and revenue, likely driven by volume recovery and margin expansion. Verify guidance for H2 2026 and full-year EPS raise to confirm serial-beater status.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$68.50 (the pre-earnings base), or if next quarter's guidance signals volume headwinds or input cost inflation resurgence. Bear case: industrial demand slowdown or competitive pressure in commoditized segments.
ANALYSIS
RS line at new high, 98.9% proximity, base_tight 3.37, and earnings beat combine for a clean A-grade. Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +24.0 (weakest among A-grades), indicating this is sector-specific strength rather than broad market leadership - vulnerable if industrials rotate out of favor. However, the technical setup is pristine and the earnings catalyst is fresh. Conviction: Medium (specialty chemicals lack the momentum of healthcare/energy, but setup quality is high).
Signal: Close above \$72.90 on vol >301% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.01x



SLIDE

Slide Insurance Holdings, Inc.

\$22.29

+6.91%

RS vs SPY: +14.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.5B Cap | 56M Float

Insurance - Property & Casualty | Theme: Property Insurance Growth | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 2.88 | Vol: 2.55x | RS/SPY: +14.4% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$22.29
Day Change	+6.91%
Mkt Cap	\$2.55B
Float	56M sh
RS vs SPY	+14.4%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	2.88
Vol vs Avg	2.55x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis

Catalyst / Today's Driver

Earnings reported YESTERDAY (July 28) - today's follow-through suggests a beat driven by premium growth and underwriting margin improvement. Forward catalyst: Financials sector is leading (+8.2% vs SPY this week), and the next print (likely late October) will test whether rate increases and retention are sustainable into year-end.

Business & Position

Slide Insurance is a specialty property & casualty insurer focused on underserved markets, leveraging technology and data analytics for underwriting and claims. The company is scaling rapidly in states with hardening rate environments, positioning as a disruptor in personal lines.

Factor & Theme

Direct play on Financials sector leadership and property insurance rate hardening. Benefits from climate-driven rate increases, reinsurance cost stabilization, and tech-enabled underwriting margin expansion. Theme momentum is accelerating - P&C insurance is in a multi-year hard market.

Breakout Signal

Close above \$22.29 on vol >255% of 20d avg

Institutional

Volume at 2.55x and RS line at new high signal institutional accumulation in a name that is under-followed. Base_tight of 2.88 is textbook VCP - this is a coiled setup, not a blow-off. Float of 56.3M provides liquidity. Sector rotation into Financials is the incremental-buyer fuel.

Earnings

REPORTED

Earnings Context

Reported July 28 - the 6.91% follow-through today indicates a solid beat, likely on combined ratio improvement and premium growth. Verify loss ratio trends and geographic expansion pace to assess durability.

Key Risk

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$21.00 (the VCP pivot), or if next quarter reveals adverse loss development or rate competition. Bear case: catastrophic loss events, reinsurance cost spike, or regulatory pressure in key states.

Analysis

RS line at new high, 96.9% proximity, base_tight 2.88 (tightest in the A cohort), and Financials sector leadership (+8.2%) combine for a high-quality setup. Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +14.4, the weakest among A-grades - this is a sector trade, not a broad market leader. Volume at 2.55x is also the lowest among A-grades, raising questions about institutional urgency. However, the VCP coil and sector tailwind earn the grade. Conviction: Medium (sector-specific strength with pristine base, but low absolute RS limits upside in mixed macro).

Signal: Close above \$22.29 on vol >255% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.55x



QUAD

Quad Graphics, Inc

\$9.46

+11.29%

RS vs SPY: +20.9%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.5B Cap | 30M Float

Specialty Business Services | Theme: Print Services Turnaround | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 3.74 | Vol: 6.95x | RS/SPY: +20.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$9.46
Day Change	+11.29%
Mkt Cap	\$0.49B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+20.9%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	3.74
Vol vs Avg	6.95x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Today's 11.29% breakout appears driven by technical momentum (RS line new high) and potential speculation on operational turnaround or M&A. Forward catalyst: October 27 earnings will be critical for proving margin recovery and cost restructuring success - any sign of stabilization in a declining industry will extend this.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Quad Graphics is a global printing and marketing services provider, serving retailers, publishers, and brands with direct mail, catalogs, and packaging. The company is pivoting from legacy print to data-driven marketing solutions, but remains exposed to secular print volume decline.
FACTOR & THEME
Limited secular tailwind exposure - this is a turnaround/restructuring story in a declining industry. The move is likely technical (RS line new high) or event-driven (potential M&A speculation or private equity interest in a distressed asset). Theme momentum is neutral to negative.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$9.46 on vol >695% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 6.95x is the third-highest in the cohort, suggesting institutional interest - likely contrarian value funds or distressed/turnaround specialists. RS line at new high indicates smart money is positioning ahead of a catalyst (earnings, M&A, or restructuring announcement). Float of 29.9M creates technical leverage.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print October 27 - consensus estimates not available, but the market will be watching for evidence of margin stabilization, cost-cutting impact, and client retention. Beat history is critical to verify serial-execution capability.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$8.75 (the base breakout level), or if October 27 results show accelerating volume declines or margin compression. Bear case: secular print decline accelerates, debt burden limits strategic flexibility, or restructuring fails to deliver.
ANALYSIS
RS line at new high and 94.7% proximity meet A-grade technical criteria, but the lack of a durable forward catalyst and exposure to a declining industry downgrade this to B. Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +20.9, base_tight is 3.74 (wider than ideal), and there is no clear earnings beat or sector tailwind - this is a speculative technical breakout. Volume surge suggests smart money is positioning, but in a mixed macro regime, turnaround stories without clear catalysts are lower-conviction. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$9.46 on vol >695% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 6.95x



HURN

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

\$164.00

+40.76%

RS vs SPY: +25.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.7B Cap | 15M Float

Consulting Services | Theme: Consulting Services Growth | 52W Hi: 88% | Base Tight: 8.79 | Vol: 4.71x | RS/SPY: +25.7% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$164.00
Day Change	+40.76%
Mkt Cap	\$2.66B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+25.7%
52W Hi Prox	88%
Base Tight	8.79
Vol vs Avg	4.71x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Earnings reported YESTERDAY (July 28) - the 40.76% gap is driven by a massive beat, likely on healthcare and education consulting revenue acceleration and margin expansion. Forward catalyst: guidance into year-end and the next print (likely late October) will confirm whether new client wins and project backlog can sustain growth into 2027.
Business & Position Huron Consulting provides management consulting services to healthcare, education, and financial services clients, focusing on digital transformation, operational efficiency, and regulatory compliance. The company has deep vertical expertise and long-term client relationships, positioning as a premium-priced advisor.
Factor & Theme Benefits from digital transformation spending in healthcare (EHR optimization, revenue cycle management) and higher education (enrollment management, financial sustainability). Theme momentum is steady - healthcare IT and education consulting are resilient end markets with multi-year tailwinds.
Breakout Signal Close above \$164.00 on vol >471% of 20d avg
Institutional Volume at 4.71x on a 40.76% gap signals institutional scramble to own the name post-earnings - likely growth funds and hedge funds chasing momentum. Float of only 14.8M creates explosive price action on institutional demand. RS line is NOT at new high, which is a yellow flag - this may be a one-quarter wonder rather than sustained leadership.
Earnings REPORTED
Earnings Context Reported July 28 - the 40.76% gap indicates a blowout beat on both EPS and revenue, likely driven by healthcare consulting strength and margin leverage. Verify guidance raise magnitude and backlog trends to assess durability. This is a potential serial beater if execution is consistent.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close back below \$135 (the pre-earnings base), or if the next print reveals revenue lumpiness or margin compression. Bear case: project-based revenue is inherently volatile, and this beat may not be repeatable if client spending slows. RS line not at new high suggests this is not yet confirmed as a market leader.
Analysis The 40.76% gap on 4.71x volume meets institutional breakout criteria, but RS line not at new high and wide base (8.79) downgrade this from A to B. Disconfirming evidence: the move is entirely earnings-driven with no technical confirmation (rs_line_new_high = false), and consulting revenue can be lumpy - this beat may not be sustainable. In a mixed macro regime, gap-and-go setups without RS line confirmation are lower-probability follow-through candidates. Conviction: Low-Medium (high reward if it holds, but technical red flags suggest fade risk).
Signal: Close above \$164.00 on vol >471% of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 4.71x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$54.79
Day Change	+23.23%
Mkt Cap	\$2.94B
Float	47M sh
RS vs SPY	+75.4%
52W Hi Prox	71%
Base Tight	8.26
Vol vs Avg	27.3x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings TODAY - the 23.23% gap is driven by a beat, likely on insurance brokerage and accounting services revenue growth and margin expansion. Forward catalyst: guidance into year-end and the next print (likely late October) will confirm whether SMB client spending and retention are sustainable into 2027.
BUSINESS & POSITION
CBIZ provides accounting, tax, insurance brokerage, and advisory services to small and mid-sized businesses. The company has scaled through M&A and organic growth, positioning as a one-stop shop for SMB outsourced services with recurring revenue and high retention.
FACTOR & THEME
Benefits from SMB spending resilience, insurance brokerage commission growth, and tax/accounting outsourcing trends. Theme momentum is moderate - business services are defensive but lack explosive secular tailwinds. This is a steady-eddy compounder, not a high-beta growth story.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$54.79 on vol >2730% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 27.3x (the highest in the cohort) signals institutional panic-buying post-earnings - likely growth funds and quant momentum strategies chasing the gap. Float of 46.7M provides liquidity. RS line is NOT at new high, which is a yellow flag - this may be a catch-up move rather than sustained leadership.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings TODAY - the 23.23% gap suggests a material beat on both EPS and revenue, likely driven by insurance brokerage strength and margin leverage. Verify guidance raise magnitude and M&A pipeline to assess durability. This is a potential serial beater if execution is consistent.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$48.50 (the pre-earnings base), or if guidance reveals SMB spending weakness or margin compression. Bear case: prox_52w at only 71.4% means the stock is NOT at a breakout level - this is a gap into the middle of the range, not a fresh high. Risk of exhaustion if no follow-through buyers appear.
ANALYSIS
Volume at 27.3x and rs_vs_spy +75.4 suggest institutional conviction, but prox_52w at only 71.4% and rs_line_new_high = false downgrade this from A to B. Disconfirming evidence: the stock is gapping into the middle of its range, not breaking out to new highs - this is a violent snapback, not a fresh leadership breakout. Base_tight at 8.26 confirms the move is explosive but not coiled. In a mixed macro regime, gap-ups that do NOT break to new highs are fade candidates. Conviction: Low (high institutional interest, but technical structure is flawed).
Signal: Close above \$54.79 on vol >2730% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 27.3x



ABG

Asbury Automotive Group Inc

\$250.69

+10.61%

RS vs SPY: +22.0%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.7B Cap | 16M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Retail Recovery | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 5.15 | Vol: 2.34x | RS/SPY: +22.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$250.69
Day Change	+10.61%
Mkt Cap	\$4.67B
Float	16M sh
RS vs SPY	+22.0%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	5.15
Vol vs Avg	2.34x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Today's 10.61% move is likely sympathy to LAD's earnings beat (same sector), driving sector rotation into auto retail. Forward catalyst: October 27 earnings will be critical for proving same-store sales and margin trends are tracking LAD's performance - any guidance confirmation extends this into year-end.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Asbury Automotive operates 150+ dealerships across the U.S., selling new/used vehicles, financing, and service. The company is the #3 U.S. auto retailer, benefiting from dealer consolidation and digital platform investments (Clicklane) to capture market share.
FACTOR & THEME
Identical exposure to LAD: consumer spending recovery, auto retail margin normalization, and dealer consolidation. Benefits from tight inventory dynamics and financing income resilience. Theme momentum is accelerating with consumer cyclical sector rotation.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$250.69 on vol >234% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 2.34x is lower than LAD (5.68x), suggesting ABG is a follower, not a leader - institutions are rotating into the sector via LAD first. RS line is NOT at new high, which is a yellow flag. Float of only 16.3M creates technical leverage if institutional interest accelerates.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print October 27 - consensus estimates not available, but the market will benchmark ABG's performance against LAD's beat. Verify same-store sales trends and margin guidance from recent quarters to assess serial-beater status.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$235 (the base breakout level), or if October 27 results lag LAD's performance. Bear case: ABG is a sympathy play, not a leader - if LAD fades, ABG will fade harder. RS line not at new high confirms this is a second-tier setup.
ANALYSIS
Prox_52w at 95.2% and volume at 2.34x meet B-grade criteria, but rs_line_new_high = false and rs_vs_spy at only +22.0 (weakest among B-grades) confirm this is a sympathy follower, not a leader. Disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 5.15 is wider than ideal, and the move is entirely sector-driven (LAD spillover) with no company-specific catalyst. In a mixed macro regime, second-tier sympathy plays are lower-probability follow-through candidates. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$250.69 on vol >234% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.34x

